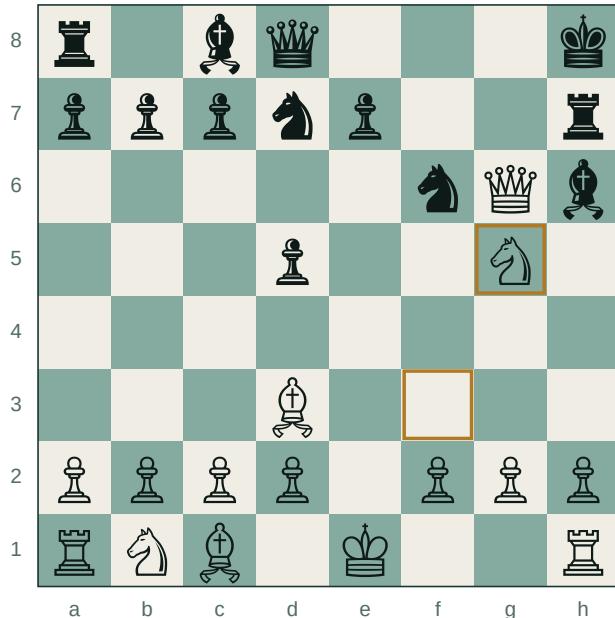


Trapping a piece: Black, move 11

Trapping a piece

Black to move



Previous move: 11.Ng5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

11...Ne5 12. Qxh6 Rxh6

11...Ne5 The knight moves from d7 to e5. From e5 it attacks queen on g6 and bishop on d3. Recorded reply: **12.Qxh6**.

12...Rxh6 The rook captures the queen on h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -2 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attacked piece is not trapped if it can give check, trade itself favorably, or open an escape through a sacrifice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A trapped piece lacks safe retreat squares. Winning it usually requires restricting its routes before attacking it, or forcing it into a cage.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace every plausible escape square for the target, including captures and counterchecks. Then find the move that closes the remaining route.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h1 and bishop on c1. Check for tactical protection.